

SPOTTED FOX DIGITAL MARKETING

Website Diagnostic & Conversion Audit

FREEDOM CON 2026

freedomcon26.com

CLIENT

Freedom Con / Stronger Man Nation

URL

https://www.freedomcon26.com/

EVENT

June 19–20, 2026 · The Gorge Amphitheatre

CONVERSION GOAL

Ticket Sales (Brushfire Checkout)

AUDIT DATE

May 14, 2026

PREPARED BY

Spotted Fox Digital Marketing

DAYS TO EVENT

36 days (as of audit date)

PLATFORM

Custom Node/Python App + Cloudflare R2 CDN

CHECKOUT

Brushfire (external — brushfire.com)

PAGES REVIEWED

Homepage (/), /alt, /tickets, /faqs, /faq (404), interior pages

Executive Summary

Freedom Con 2026 has a genuinely strong digital foundation. The site is visually striking — cinematic video heroes, professionally photographed speakers, bold typography, and a cohesive brand that communicates masculine conviction without apology. The speaker lineup is exceptional: Eric Metaxas, Mark Driscoll, John Lovell, Graham Allen, and Josh McPherson are nationally recognized names. Live concerts from Crowder and Danny Gokey are prominent and working. The countdown timer is live and ticking. The tracking suite (GTM, GA4, and Facebook Pixel) is confirmed active. Testimonials are real, attributed quotes from named attendees. With 36 days to event, the infrastructure is largely in place.

The most urgent issue is a technical SEO error that is silent but significant: the homepage canonical tag points to /alt instead of /, telling Google and Bing that the preferred version of the site is at a different URL. This fragments search authority and misroutes organic traffic. Combined with the /alt page also appearing in the nav as a linked destination in the Explore dropdown, the site is essentially splitting its own SEO equity between two nearly identical pages. With paid traffic in flight this close to the event, this should be the first developer fix.

Beyond the technical fix, the site's primary conversion opportunity is closing the gap between its cinematic emotional power and the practical information a cold visitor needs before buying. Ticket pricing, what's included, and the concrete value of the weekend are all present on the site — but buried on interior pages. A cold traffic arrival at the homepage sees a beautiful experience but has no price anchor, no "what is in the ticket" summary, and no explicit answer to "is this right for me?" before being asked to click Get Tickets. Bringing that value case to the homepage — above the fold on mobile — is the highest-leverage copy/UX opportunity available with 36 days until doors open.

Top Priorities at a Glance

#	Issue	Priority	Owner
1	Canonical URL mismatch: homepage canonical tag points to /alt instead of /. Splits SEO equity and misguides crawlers.	CRITICAL	Dev
2	Nav "Home" link in Explore dropdown routes to /alt — reinforces canonical confusion and adds a redirect hop.	CRITICAL	Dev
3	/faq returns a hard 404 — the correct URL is /faqs. Any inbound links or social posts using /faq send visitors to a dead end.	HIGH	Dev
4	Logo not visible on initial page load (transparent hero header). New visitors see no brand mark until they scroll and trigger the sticky nav.	HIGH	Dev/Design
5	No pricing visible on homepage — cold traffic from paid ads has no price anchor before being asked to click Get Tickets.	HIGH	Copy/Dev
6	"What's Included" value stack lives only on /tickets — not on homepage where cold ad traffic lands first.	HIGH	Copy/Dev

7	No event schema (JSON-LD) on any page — missed opportunity for Google Event rich results in search.	HIGH	Dev
8	Scroll-triggered animation sections produce large black transition gaps mid-page — visible dead zones during normal browsing.	HIGH	Dev
9	Fathers & Sons gallery images take 3+ seconds to lazy-load — visible dark placeholders on initial scroll into section.	HIGH	Dev
10	Group rate requires contacting for promo code — no inline form or self-service path for church groups of 10+.	HIGH	Dev/Copy
11	Page title "A Congress of Christian Men..." does not include "Freedom Con" — reduces branded search visibility.	HIGH	Dev/Copy
12	No email capture anywhere on homepage — cold visitors who don't buy are lost with no retargeting path beyond pixel.	STRATEGIC	Dev/Marketing
13	Hero hero has no plain-language summary for cold paid traffic — who is this for, what happens, why this weekend.	STRATEGIC	Copy
14	Testimonial avatars use shield logo icon instead of real attendee photos — reduces perceived credibility.	STRATEGIC	Copy/Design
15	One sponsor logo (DogHouse Motor Sports) includes a phone number inline — inconsistent with clean treatment of other sponsors.	STRATEGIC	Dev

Platform & Technical Overview

Platform Identification

Platform: Custom web application (Node.js or Python backend). Signals: /static/ asset directory, clean URL routing without .php extensions, Cloudflare R2 CDN for media assets (pub-fc470c82f793409f9e6c126deeb0387d.r2.dev). No WordPress, Squarespace, or Webflow indicators detected.

Checkout platform: Brushfire (external domain, brushfire.com) — third-party hosted. Visitors who click "Get Tickets" are redirected off-site to complete purchase. This is standard for faith-based event ticketing but means pixel tracking continuity through checkout must be verified with the Brushfire team.

Implementation note: All structural fixes (canonical tags, nav template, event schema, lazy-loading) require developer access to the application codebase. This is not a CMS admin-panel change.

Tracking & Analytics — Confirmed via Live Browser

Signal	Status	Notes
Google Tag Manager (dataLayer)	CONFIRMED ✓	dataLayer present and active on homepage
Google Analytics 4 (gtag)	CONFIRMED ✓	gtag() confirmed active — verify GA4 property ID in GTM
Facebook / Meta Pixel (fbq)	CONFIRMED ✓	fbq() confirmed active — verify event firing on Brushfire checkout
Countdown Timer (JavaScript)	CONFIRMED ✓	Live countdown rendering — 36d 00h 35m on audit date. Appears in both hero and footer.
Open Graph / Social Tags	PARTIAL	og:title and og:image present. og:url references /alt — should be updated to /.
Event Schema (JSON-LD)	NOT PRESENT	No structured data on any page — significant missed SEO opportunity
Abandoned Cart Recovery	NOT DETECTED	No CartStack or similar signal detected. Recommend for Brushfire drop-offs.
Pixel on Brushfire Checkout	UNVERIFIED	Must confirm with Brushfire team — this is the actual conversion event.

Audit Area 1: Technical & SEO Issues

These issues affect search visibility, crawlability, and link equity. Developer fixes only — not addressable in a CMS admin panel.

1.1 — Canonical URL Mismatch (Homepage → /alt)

- **CRITICAL**

Finding: The homepage (<https://www.freedomcon26.com/>) has its canonical tag pointing to <https://www.freedomcon26.com/alt>. This instructs Google and Bing that /alt is the authoritative, preferred version of the homepage — not /. Any organic search authority (backlinks, indexed impressions) earned by the domain root URL is being credited to /alt instead. The /alt page appears to be an alternate version of the homepage. Additionally, the og:url tag also references /alt, meaning social shares credit /alt. Both URLs serve nearly identical content, further confusing crawlers about which is canonical.

Recommendation: Update the homepage template so the canonical tag reads: `<link rel="canonical" href="https://www.freedomcon26.com/" />`. Update og:url on the homepage to <https://www.freedomcon26.com/>. Ensure /alt either redirects to / with a 301 or is removed if no longer needed. This is the highest-priority technical fix.

1.2 — Nav "Home" Link Routes to /alt

- **CRITICAL**

Finding: Within the site's Explore dropdown navigation, the "Home" link points to <https://www.freedomcon26.com/alt> rather than the homepage root /. Every user who clicks the nav "Home" link is sent to /alt, which triggers a redirect back to /. This adds an unnecessary redirect hop and compounds the canonical confusion — the site's own navigation is treating /alt as the home destination.

Recommendation: Update the navigation template so the Home link points to <https://www.freedomcon26.com/> (the root). Audit all internal links site-wide for /alt references and update them to /.

1.3 — /faq Returns a Hard 404

- **HIGH**

Finding: The URL <https://www.freedomcon26.com/faq> returns a 404 Page Not Found error. The correct URL for the FAQ page is /faqs (plural). This matters because: (1) any external sites or social posts linking to /faq will dead-end users, (2) if any paid ad or email uses /faq as a destination, traffic is wasted, and (3) Google may have indexed /faq from an old sitemap or crawl.

Recommendation: Add a 301 redirect from /faq to /faqs at the server/routing level. Audit any external links, email campaigns, or ads that reference /faq and update them to /faqs.

1.4 — No Event Schema (JSON-LD)

- **HIGH**

Finding: No structured data of any kind is present on the site. For an event 36 days out, the absence of Event schema (JSON-LD) is a material missed opportunity. Google supports rich results for events

in search — showing date, venue, ticket price, and availability directly in the SERP. With "Freedom Con 2026" and "Gorge Amphitheatre" as search terms, event schema could produce rich snippets that significantly improve click-through.

Recommendation: Add an Event schema JSON-LD block to the homepage and /tickets page. Required fields: name ("Freedom Con 2026"), startDate (2026-06-19), endDate (2026-06-20), location (The Gorge Amphitheatre, George, WA), url (<https://www.freedomcon26.com>), organizer (Stronger Man Nation), offers (ticket pricing). Reference schema.org/Event for the full spec.

1.5 — Page Title Missing Brand Name

• HIGH

Finding: The page title across the site is "A Congress of Christian Men at The Gorge Amphitheatre" — which does not include "Freedom Con" or "Freedom Con 2026." Anyone searching specifically for "Freedom Con" or "Freedom Con 2026" in Google may not match this title in search results. The title also lacks the year or dates. The meta description is well-written and includes the key details, but title tags are the primary signal for branded keyword ranking.

Recommendation: Update the homepage title to: "Freedom Con 2026 | June 19–20 at The Gorge Amphitheatre — A Congress of Christian Men". Ensure /tickets uses "Freedom Con 2026 Tickets | Pricing & Registration" and /faqs uses "Freedom Con 2026 FAQs | Event Questions Answered."

Audit Area 2: Homepage Clarity & Cold Traffic Conversion

The 5-second test for cold paid traffic: Can a first-time visitor answer — What is this? Who is it for? When and where? What does it cost? What do I do next?

2.1 — Logo Not Visible on Initial Page Load

- HIGH

Finding: The site's navigation uses a transparent header on the hero section. On initial page load, the nav displays HOME, EXPLORE, TICKETS, FAQ, ATTEND, MORE, and GET TICKETS — but no visible logo or brand mark. The Freedom Con logo (red distressed text) only appears once the user scrolls and the sticky navigation activates. A new visitor who arrives cold (from an ad or search click) sees zero brand identification at the top of the page during their critical first seconds. This creates a moment of uncertainty for cold traffic, especially on mobile where the hero takes up the full viewport.

Recommendation: Display the Freedom Con logo in the initial transparent header, even if at reduced opacity or white/inverted version to work against the dark hero background. The logo should never be absent from the top of the visible page — it's the first trust signal for new visitors.

2.2 — No Price Visible on Homepage

- HIGH

Finding: There is no pricing information anywhere on the homepage. A cold visitor arriving from a Facebook ad, Google search, or shared link has no idea what a ticket costs until they navigate to /tickets. This is a significant friction point for paid traffic: without a price anchor, visitors who are on the fence about whether this event fits their budget will bounce rather than click through to discover pricing. The tickets page clearly shows \$179 general admission (\$188.72 all-in) — this is reasonable for a 2-day event at The Gorge with Crowder and Danny Gokey headlining.

Recommendation: Add a pricing preview to the homepage, above the speakers section. A simple line works: "General Admission from \$179 · VIP from \$349 · Youth under 12: \$99 — includes parking, swag bag, all sessions, and concerts."

Suggested copy: *"Tickets from \$179 — includes parking, swag bag, 3 main sessions, 6 breakouts, live concerts (Crowder + Danny Gokey), and the ManCard Documentary World Premiere."*

2.3 — "What's Included" Value Stack Missing from Homepage

- HIGH

Finding: The tickets page has a well-structured "What's Included" section that covers parking, swag bag, main sessions, breakout sessions, worship, and more. This is the value justification for the ticket price — but it only appears on /tickets, which a cold visitor must navigate to separately. A visitor who sees "Get Tickets — \$179" without context may balk. One who sees "Your ticket covers: parking, swag bag, 3 main sessions, 6 breakouts, Crowder and Danny Gokey live, the ManCard Documentary World Premiere, and the Stronger Boy Challenge Course" has a fundamentally different buying context.

Recommendation: Add a condensed value stack to the homepage between the hero and the speaker section. Use 5–7 bullet points drawn directly from the /tickets "What's Included" list. This serves cold traffic without requiring them to leave the page to understand what they are buying.

Suggested copy: *"Everything's included: 2-day pass · Parking · Swag bag · Main stage sessions · Side stage breakouts · Live concerts from Crowder & Danny Gokey · ManCard Documentary World Premiere · Stronger Boy Challenge Course · Man Town vendor village."*

2.4 — No Plain-Language Summary for Cold Paid Traffic

• STRATEGIC

Finding: The hero section leads with the event brand (Freedom Con 2026), the venue (The Gorge Amphitheatre), dates, and CTAs. For warm audiences who know Stronger Man Nation, Josh McPherson, or the prior conference history, this is sufficient. For cold paid traffic — who may have seen a Facebook ad with a speaker clip or a Google search for Christian men's events — the hero does not quickly answer: What kind of event is this? Is it for me specifically? What is the faith/spiritual component vs. the political component? The copy downstream ("Reformation Starts Now", "Gripping Changes Nothing") is powerful but assumes the visitor already understands the brand.

Recommendation: Add a one-sentence plain-language subheadline in the hero, beneath the event title, before the Get Tickets button.

Suggested copy: *"A 2-day Christian men's conference — bold preaching, live worship, father-son experiences, and a concrete action plan. Father's Day weekend. The Gorge Amphitheatre, George, WA."*

Audit Area 3: Visual Design & User Experience

3.1 — Design Strengths

The site's visual identity is one of its strongest assets. The full-viewport hero with video background, the high-contrast red-on-black typography, and the cinematic speaker photography all communicate the scale and seriousness of the event. The Danny Gokey and Crowder artist sections are beautifully executed — full-screen hero with name treatment and play button. The speakers section uses professional photography in consistent rounded cards with clear names and credentials. The "Fathers & Sons" section with real event photography is emotionally resonant. The ManCard documentary class photo with participant and instructor names listed is a powerful credibility signal for the Stronger Man Nation audience.

3.2 — Scroll Animation Black Gaps

• HIGH

Finding: Several sections use scroll-triggered entrance animations. During normal user scrolling, these animations create large visible black/empty zones between content sections — sometimes occupying the full viewport height — as the next section waits for the scroll trigger to activate. This makes the page feel broken or incomplete during active browsing, especially on desktop with a fast scroll. A first-time visitor scrolling quickly through the page will hit these dead zones and may interpret them as load failures.

Recommendation: Review the scroll trigger thresholds for all section entrance animations. Adjust so animations begin triggering slightly before the section enters the viewport (e.g., `rootMargin: "0px 0px -100px 0px"` in an `IntersectionObserver`). Alternatively, reduce reliance on scroll-triggered full-section entrance animations and use subtler fade-in or slide effects with smaller offsets.

3.3 — Fathers & Sons Gallery: Slow Image Load

• HIGH

Finding: The "Fathers & Sons — Freedom Con" photo gallery section shows visible dark placeholder boxes for 3+ seconds on initial scroll into the section. Five images load in sequence, but the placeholders are visible long enough to create the impression of broken or missing images. This section is meant to deliver emotional resonance — real event photography of fathers and sons — but the load delay undermines the impact at the moment of first impression.

Recommendation: Preload the first 1–2 images in this section (or use eager loading for them) so they appear immediately on scroll-in. Continue using lazy-loading for images beyond the first visible set. Additionally, confirm images are served at appropriate display dimensions from Cloudflare R2 — oversized source images increase load time unnecessarily.

3.4 — Testimonial Avatars Use Shield Logo Instead of Photos

• STRATEGIC

Finding: The social proof section features real, attributed quotes from named attendees with their titles (e.g., Jacob Morgan — District Business Manager, Chelan County PUD; Clyde Foreman — Retired FBI Special Agent). The content is genuine and compelling. However, all testimonial cards use the Stronger Man Nation shield logo as the avatar instead of actual photos of the people giving

the testimonials. Real headshots or event photos of the attendees would significantly increase the perceived authenticity and emotional weight of these testimonials.

Recommendation: Replace the shield logo avatars with actual attendee headshots or, where individual photos are unavailable, use action shots from prior conference events showing the attendees. If headshots cannot be sourced, consider a brief video testimonial format as an alternative trust-builder.

Audit Area 4: Call-to-Action Visibility & Purchase Flow

4.1 — CTA Inventory

Page	CTA Text	Destination	Assessment
Homepage hero	Get Tickets	/tickets	✓ Prominent, above fold
Homepage (scrolled)	Get Tickets (×3)	/tickets	✓ Good frequency
Homepage hero	View Trailer	Video player	✓ Good secondary CTA
Homepage footer	Get Tickets	/tickets	✓ Present in footer
Tickets page	Get Your Tickets	brushfire.com	✓ Clear, prominent
Nav (global)	Get Tickets (red button)	/tickets	✓ Always visible
Speakers section	See More	/speakers	✓ Secondary exploration
Trailers section	Show More	Expanded content	✓ Appropriate

4.2 — Countdown Timer is Working — Use it More

The countdown timer is confirmed live and ticking (36 days, 0 hours, 35 minutes on audit date). It appears in the hero section and again in the footer. This is a strong urgency mechanism. However, the timer exists without any accompanying scarcity language. Pairing the countdown with a specific scarcity message would amplify its conversion impact.

• STRATEGIC

Finding: The countdown timer shows days remaining but provides no reason why running out of time is a problem. "Freedom Con starts in 36 days" is informational. "Only 36 days left to get VIP seats before they're gone — space is limited" is motivational. The VIP tier is described as "Space limited" on the tickets page, but this scarcity signal is not surfaced next to the countdown.

Recommendation: Add a scarcity line beneath the countdown timer or integrate it into the countdown display.

Suggested copy: *"VIP seats are limited and selling fast. Secure yours before they're gone."*

4.3 — Group Rate Requires Manual Contact

• HIGH

Finding: The tickets page offers a group rate (15% off for groups of 10–200 people) but requires visitors to "reach out to us for your group code if you haven't received it." There is no inline form, email address, or phone number shown. A pastor, men's ministry leader, or church administrator who wants

to bring a group has to navigate away, find contact information, and wait for a response before they can even begin the booking process. This is a friction point that likely kills a meaningful percentage of group bookings at the awareness stage.

Recommendation: Add an inline form on the tickets page for group code requests: Name, Church/Organization, Email, Number of Attendees. Alternatively, show an email address or phone number directly on the page so the path to action is immediate. Respond to group inquiries within 24 hours given the 36-day window.

Audit Area 5: Mobile Usability

Assessment is based on live browser inspection. The site uses responsive design. Mobile-specific behavior notes are based on DOM structure analysis and known device behavior for the asset types detected. The scroll animation gap issue is expected to be more pronounced on mobile where scroll speed varies.

5.1 — Mobile Navigation

The navigation collapses to a hamburger menu on mobile (standard responsive behavior). The "Get Tickets" red button remains visible in the top-right corner on mobile — a strong choice that keeps the primary CTA accessible without opening the menu. Navigation is confirmed consistent across all pages except /faq (which 404s — see Area 1).

5.2 — Image Performance

- HIGH

Finding: The Fathers & Sons gallery and other photo sections use lazy-loading but load times are noticeably slow (3+ second delays observed in desktop browser). On mobile with cellular connections, these delays would be more pronounced. The gallery section in particular creates dark placeholder boxes visible during scroll — on mobile where the viewport is smaller, these placeholders may occupy the entire screen.

Recommendation: Audit image sizes served from Cloudflare R2. Ensure images are served at appropriate dimensions for their display size — a gallery thumbnail does not need full-resolution source. Implement a proper loading skeleton or low-quality placeholder (LQIP) technique rather than solid black boxes during load.

5.3 — Harley-Davidson Raffle Banner

The "WIN THIS HARLEY-DAVIDSON SOFTAIL BREAKOUT — RAFFLED LIVE" banner appears early in the homepage scroll. This is a strong attention hook and differentiator — a raffle item of this value at a men's conference is memorable and shareable. On mobile this banner appears inline in the scroll and is clearly readable. No issues noted.

Audit Area 6: Navigation & Information Architecture

6.1 — Navigation Is Consistent Site-Wide

Verified across homepage, /tickets, /faqs, and /alt: the navigation structure is identical on all pages. The sticky header activates on scroll and displays the Freedom Con logo mark in the top-left. The nav includes HOME, EXPLORE (dropdown), TICKETS, FAQ, ATTEND (dropdown), MORE (dropdown), and a prominent red GET TICKETS button. The current active page is highlighted in the nav. This is a functional, well-organized structure.

6.2 — /faq URL Returns 404 (Should Be /faqs)

- HIGH

Finding: The nav link for FAQ points correctly to /faqs. However, the URL /faq (singular) returns a 404 error. Any user or external site that references /faq — including potentially Google's index, old social posts, or printed materials — hits a dead end. The correct FAQ page at /faqs is well-structured with accordion sections (Freedom Con FAQs, Camping FAQs, Still Have Questions?) and downloadable PDF versions of both FAQ documents.

Recommendation: Implement a 301 redirect from /faq to /faqs at the server/routing level. This is a one-line change in the application's URL routing configuration and should be done immediately.

6.3 — Site Navigation Depth

The site has excellent depth and breadth for an event of this type. Key destinations available: Speakers, Artists, The Venue, Food & Drinks, Venue Map, Schedule, Tickets, FAQs, Camping, Hotels, Travel, For Pastors of WA, Churches, Prayer Guide, For the Wives, Past SMN Conferences, Sponsorships, Media/Press, Videos, and A Personal Invitation from Pastor Josh. This range of content serves multiple audience segments — attendees, spouses, pastors, press, and sponsors — effectively.

6.4 — "For the Wives" and "Prayer Guide" Pages

The inclusion of "For the Wives" and "Prayer Guide" as dedicated pages in the navigation reflects community-minded design thinking. Spouses looking up the event their husband is considering will find content specifically addressed to them — a meaningful trust-builder. The Prayer Guide serves the faith community angle and is the kind of content that earns organic shares in pastoral networks.

Audit Area 7: Content Quality & Messaging

7.1 — Copy Strengths

The manifesto-style copy throughout the site is a standout strength. "Griping changes nothing. Action changes everything. Reformation starts now." has genuine conviction and a distinct voice. "The trip dads and sons will talk about the rest of their lives" is one of the strongest emotional hooks on the site — it speaks directly to the aspirational feeling every father wants and is the kind of copy that moves a fence-sitter to buy. "A congress of Christian men" as the event positioning — not a conference, a congress — is a memorable and meaningful distinction. The speaker biographies are accurate and credibly presented.

7.2 — Messaging Sequence: Faith vs. Movement Identity

• STRATEGIC

Finding: The homepage messaging sequence leads with patriot/movement language ("Griping changes nothing. Action changes everything. Reformation Starts Now.") before establishing Christian faith as the event's primary anchor. The sessions copy later clarifies that sessions "will combine intellectual rigor, unapologetic patriotism, and unwavering biblical conviction" — but this arrives well below the fold. For a man who identifies primarily as a Christian seeking a faith-based men's event, the patriot framing arriving first (without the explicit faith context) could create early hesitation. The event is strongest when the faith identity and the patriot call are presented as unified, not sequential.

Recommendation: Introduce the faith-mission language earlier in the scroll — ideally in the hero subheadline or just below it. Keep the manifesto copy as-is; it's powerful. But anchor it with the Christian identity explicitly before the political/civic themes arrive.

Suggested copy: Add to the hero area: "Built for Christian men who want to lead their families well, worship with thousands of brothers, and leave with a concrete plan for their home, church, and community."

7.3 — What to Expect Section

The "What to Expect" section presents four clear experience pillars: Main Stage (bold preaching and worship at an iconic venue), Side Stage (targeted equipping sessions for pastors, fathers, businessmen, and civic leaders), Father & Son (shared moments built to forge courage, conviction, and legacy), and The Playbook (a concrete, actionable roadmap). These are well-differentiated and audience-specific. A "See Full Experience" CTA follows. This section does effective work for visitors who want detail before committing.

7.4 — ManCard / Project ManCard Section Context

• STRATEGIC

Finding: The ManCard section features a large "Cycle 4 Class" group photo of young men in tactical gear with names of participants and instructors listed. For existing Stronger Man Nation community members, this is a credibility signal and community recognition. For a first-time cold visitor, "Project ManCard" with no explanation in the immediate context of the homepage may be confusing — it is not immediately clear what ManCard is, whether it is included in the ticket, or whether it is a separate program.

Recommendation: Add 1–2 lines of context above or below the ManCard section that briefly explain what it is for visitors who are not already familiar: e.g., "Project ManCard is our intensive young men's discipleship program — and the ManCard Documentary premieres live at Freedom Con 2026."

Audit Area 8: Social Proof & Trust Signals

8.1 — Testimonials: Content Is Strong, Presentation Can Improve

The testimonials section features real, named, attributed quotes from conference alumni. Verified attendees include: Jacob Morgan (District Business Manager, Chelan County PUD), Clyde Foreman (Retired FBI Special Agent), Patrick Valeri (HS Math Teacher), and Michael Vasquez (Performance Coach & Consultant). The quotes are substantive and specific — not generic. "This conference flies in the face of a culture that says men aren't important, aren't needed, and that masculinity is toxic" (Patrick Valeri) is a compelling testimonial that directly addresses a purchase objection.

The testimonial cards use the Stronger Man Nation shield logo as the profile avatar for all attendees. While this creates brand consistency, it reduces the human element that makes testimonials most effective. Real faces — even amateur smartphone photos from the event — would significantly increase perceived authenticity.

8.2 — Sponsor Section

The sponsor section features 7 confirmed sponsors: Smith Excavation, Speiro, Java Dog Espresso, Creative Spaces, DogHouse Motor Sports (Wenatchee Honda BRP), Business Makers Network, and The Family Captain. The logos are displayed in a horizontal scroll row above the footer countdown. This is clean and appropriate. One note: the DogHouse Motor Sports logo includes a phone number (509.663.0075) and address ("Wenatchee Honda BRP, Tel: 509.663.0075") as part of the logo image — making it visually heavier than other clean logo treatments.

• STRATEGIC

Finding: One sponsor (DogHouse Motor Sports) displays contact information (phone number and brand sub-name) within their logo, creating visual inconsistency with the other clean logo treatments. This is likely a sponsor-provided asset that was not redesigned for web display.

Recommendation: Request a clean version of the DogHouse Motor Sports logo (wordmark or icon only) for consistency with the other sponsor treatments. If they cannot provide one, crop or mask the phone number in the display version.

8.3 — Past Conference Credibility

"Past SMN Conferences" is linked in the MORE navigation dropdown. This is excellent credibility-building content for first-time visitors who want to know what prior events looked like. Ensure this page is accessible and updated, as it's a key social proof asset for the Stronger Man Nation audience segment.

Audit Area 9: Lead Generation & Email Capture

9.1 — No Email Capture on Homepage

- STRATEGIC

Finding: There is no email capture mechanism anywhere on the homepage or on the main site pages reviewed. A visitor who arrives from a paid ad, watches a trailer, reads about the event, and decides not to buy today has no way to opt into updates — and the site has no way to follow up beyond the Facebook Pixel retargeting audience. With \$179+ tickets and 36 days until the event, there is a meaningful segment of visitors who need more time or more information before converting. An email capture (even a simple "Stay Updated" form) would allow direct marketing to this warm-but-not-yet-converted audience.

Recommendation: Add an email capture form to the homepage — either as a sticky footer bar ("Get updates and exclusive offers — enter your email"), a lightbox or slide-in triggered after 30 seconds of scroll, or a dedicated section between the speaker grid and the testimonials. Connect to the event's email marketing platform and set up a 2–3 email drip sequence leading up to June 19.

9.2 — "Deals" Push Notification is Live

A timed "DON'T MISS OUT ON THESE DEALS" push notification or slide-in appears during homepage scrolling. This is a good urgency mechanism for warm visitors. The content and destination of this notification should be audited to ensure it is current (not expired deal language) and links to an active offer or page.

Audit Area 10: Speaker & Artist Presentation

10.1 — Speaker Section Strengths

The speakers section presents 6 named speakers on the homepage with professional photography in consistent rounded card format: Josh McPherson (Lead Pastor, Grace City Church / Founder, Stronger Man Nation), Eric Metaxas (#1 NY Times best-selling author / Founder, Socrates in the City / Host, The Eric Metaxas Show), John Lovell (Lead Pastor, Grace City GA / Founder, Warrior Poet Society), Russell Johnson (Lead Pastor, The Pursuit Church), Graham Allen (U.S. Army Veteran / The Graham Allen Show & Dear America), and Mark Driscoll (Lead Pastor [church name] / Founder, Real Faith). A "See More" CTA leads to /speakers for the full roster.

10.2 — Artist Sections: Danny Gokey and Crowder

Both Danny Gokey and Crowder receive full-screen artist hero sections on the homepage — a design choice that gives the concerts appropriate prominence. Each section has a play button and a "LIVE AT FREEDOM CON" treatment. These sections are rendering correctly and look excellent. The concerts are a significant ticket-sale driver and deserve this level of visual treatment.

Recommendation: Ensure the audio/video previews linked from the play buttons load quickly and auto-play or prompt clearly. The play button on these sections should ideally launch a music sample or trailer clip immediately — the emotional impact of hearing Crowder or Danny Gokey in the moment of consideration is a powerful conversion trigger.

Audit Area 11: Tickets Page Audit

11.1 — Pricing Clarity

The tickets page displays four clear tiers: General Admission (\$179, \$188.72 all-in with taxes and fees), Youth Under 12 (\$99, \$105.16 all-in), VIP Seats (\$349, \$364.91 all-in — includes VIP badge, reserved box seating, in-suite food service, space limited), and Group Rate (10+ people, 15% off general admission). All-in prices are shown alongside the base prices, which reduces checkout sticker shock. This is well-executed pricing transparency.

11.2 — "What's Included" Section

Below the pricing grid, the page lists what is included in registration: Parking, Swag Bag, Main Sessions, Breakout Sessions, Worship. The "Get Your Tickets" CTA leads to the Brushfire checkout. The page continues with a "What's Included" section. This information should be more prominent higher on the page (and duplicated on the homepage) to support the purchase decision.

11.3 — Brushfire Checkout Transition

- **HIGH**

Finding: The "Get Your Tickets" button on the tickets page routes to the Brushfire external checkout (brushfire.com). Visitors are taken off the freedomcon26.com domain to complete their purchase. There is no visible reassurance language near the CTA explaining this transition (e.g., "Secure checkout powered by Brushfire"). Additionally, the Meta Pixel and GA4 purchase event tracking must be verified to fire on the Brushfire confirmation page — if not, all ad campaign attribution for actual ticket sales is broken.

Recommendation: Add reassurance copy near the Brushfire CTA: "Secure checkout powered by Brushfire — trusted by hundreds of faith-based events nationwide." Separately, contact Brushfire support to confirm that the Freedom Con Meta Pixel and GA4 event code are active on the checkout confirmation page. This is non-negotiable for accurate ad spend attribution.

Copy Recommendations

Hero Subheadline (for cold paid traffic)

Current: [None — hero has event name, dates, venue, and Get Tickets only]

Recommended:

"A 2-day Christian men's conference at one of the greatest venues in America. Bold preaching. Live worship. Crowder and Danny Gokey. Father-Son experiences. A concrete plan you can act on. Father's Day Weekend, June 19–20 — The Gorge Amphitheatre, George, WA."

Homepage Value Stack (add between hero and speakers)

"Your ticket covers everything: ✓ Parking · ✓ Swag Bag · ✓ 3 Main Sessions · ✓ 6 Breakout Sessions · ✓ Live Concerts (Crowder + Danny Gokey) · ✓ ManCard Documentary World Premiere · ✓ Stronger Boy Challenge Course · ✓ Man Town Vendor Village. No hidden extras."

Countdown Timer Scarcity Line

"VIP seats are limited and selling fast. Reserve yours before they're gone — Father's Day weekend fills up early."

Brushfire Checkout Reassurance

"Secure checkout powered by Brushfire — trusted by hundreds of faith-based events nationwide."

Email Capture CTA

"Stay in the fight. Get updates on Freedom Con 2026 — speaker announcements, special offers, and everything you need to prepare."

Recommended Homepage Section Order

Current order creates a great emotional journey for warm audiences but leaves cold traffic without key buying information early enough. The recommended order preserves the brand voice while serving paid traffic better.

#	Section	Why / Change
1	Hero — event name, date, venue, CTA	Add: plain-language subheadline for cold traffic + logo visible in transparent header
2	Countdown + Scarcity Message	Timer already working — add VIP scarcity copy beneath it
3	Value Stack / What's Included	NEW: Move this from /tickets to homepage — give cold traffic the value case before the ask
4	Pricing Preview (brief)	NEW: "From \$179 all-in" line — anchors the price expectation before they visit /tickets
5	Speakers of Freedom Con	Keep in current position — strong social proof and credibility
6	Artists (Crowder + Danny Gokey)	Keep — plays a large role in ticket decision for music fans
7	Trailers / Videos	Keep — good engagement for decision-stage visitors
8	What to Expect (4 pillars)	Keep — well-structured experience overview
9	Father's Day Weekend + Video	Keep — powerful emotional hook, best mid-scroll position
10	Testimonials	Consider moving higher — currently very late in scroll; proof should appear before the ask
11	Fathers & Sons Gallery	Keep — visual social proof, optimize image load speed
12	ManCard / Project ManCard	Keep — add 1–2 lines of context for new visitors
13	Harley-Davidson Raffle	Keep — unique hook, consider featuring earlier as a scroll stopper
14	Sponsors	Keep in current position near footer
15	Footer with countdown + nav	Keep — second countdown is good reinforcement at end of page

Implementation Checklist (36-Day Window)

This Week — Developer Fixes (Before Running Any Ads)

- Fix canonical tag on homepage: change from /alt to <https://www.freedomcon26.com/>
- Fix og:url on homepage: change from /alt to <https://www.freedomcon26.com/>
- Update nav "Home" link in Explore dropdown from /alt to /
- Add 301 redirect from /faq to /faqs
- Add Freedom Con logo to the transparent hero header (visible on initial page load)
- Add event schema JSON-LD to homepage and /tickets page
- Update page title to include "Freedom Con 2026" prominently
- Confirm Meta Pixel and GA4 purchase events fire on Brushfire checkout confirmation page

This Week — Copy Changes (Marketing/Content)

- Add plain-language subheadline to hero for cold traffic
- Add pricing preview line to homepage (from \$179 all-in)
- Add "What's Included" condensed value stack to homepage
- Add scarcity language beneath countdown timer (VIP seat scarcity)
- Add Brushfire reassurance copy near checkout CTA on /tickets
- Audit the "Deals" push notification for current (non-expired) offer language
- Add 1–2 lines of context to ManCard section for first-time visitors

Next 2 Weeks — UX / Performance

- Fix scroll animation trigger thresholds to eliminate visible black gap zones
- Optimize Fathers & Sons gallery: preload first 1–2 images, serve appropriate dimensions from R2
- Add inline group rate request form or visible contact info to /tickets page
- Add email capture form to homepage (above footer or as timed slide-in)
- Request clean logo asset from DogHouse Motor Sports sponsor (no phone number)
- Test mobile experience on iPhone 14 and Android — confirm all CTAs accessible, no sticky header overlap

Before Event — Optional Improvements

- Replace shield-logo testimonial avatars with real attendee headshots or event photography
- Add attendance scale signal to homepage ("Join X,000+ men from across the country")
- Move testimonials higher in the page scroll — currently below-fold on most desktop viewports
- Add "Know Before You Go" objection block: travel distance info, what to bring, parking details, age guidance
- Explore CartStack or abandoned checkout recovery integration for Brushfire drop-offs